

THE PROBLEM, IN YOUR WORDS

Short-notice cancellations leave chairs empty, and filling them is a manual chase.

Today you or Carla spot the cancellation in Square, look through the Google Sheet for clients who might fit, text them from the salon phone, and keep checking for replies in between everything else.

Chasing replies by hand

"We have to keep checking replies and move down the list manually, and sometimes the appointment stays empty."

Two clients, one Saturday haircut

"Last month two clients expected the same Saturday haircut after both replied yes to a group text. Different staff members had answered them, so one client left angry."

The next person never gets asked

"We lose track of who was contacted and who declined, and sometimes nobody gets to the next person. Then the chair sits empty even though someone might have taken it."

8–12 cancellations inside 48 hours
in a typical week

Each one that isn't refilled is an empty chair, and an empty chair "affects both the salon and the stylist because they're paid on commission."

HOW THE PROTOTYPE WORKS

Add the opening once. It works the waitlist for you.

It follows the rule you chose: "one at a time in waitlist order feels fairer and avoids competing acceptances."

1 Add the opening

You or Carla enter the service, stylist, date and time. It takes a few seconds, and Square stays your real calendar.

2 Find who fits

Clients who want that service, are free then and are happy with that stylist, in waitlist order. Anyone who opted out is never texted.

3 Text one client

The text shows the service, stylist, date and time and asks them to **Reply YES or NO**. Only one client holds the offer at a time.

4 Wait for a reply

A same-day offer is held 15 minutes (60 for later dates), and a hold never runs past the appointment time. A NO or no reply moves it to the next client.

5 A YES books it

The client gets a confirmation, the front desk gets a note to add it to Square, and anyone whose time ran out hears it's been filled.

Color with Ben

on Thu, Oct 8 at 10:00 am · each person gets 60 min to reply

Waiting for **Omar Haddad** to reply · 50 min left

⚠️ Couldn't text Grace Kim at (555) 201-0106 after 3 tries, so the offer moved to the next person. Please check the number.

1. Grace Kim

2. Omar Haddad

Has the offer · 50 min left

► What happened

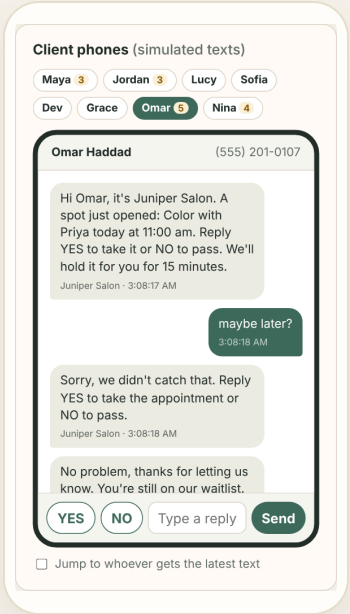
One opening on the staff board: who has the offer and how long they have left, who couldn't be reached and why, and what happens next.

WHEN SOMETHING GOES WRONG

Built so nothing slips through the cracks.

Problems are handled automatically or flagged to staff right away. Temporal, the system underneath, makes sure no opening gets lost or forgotten along the way.

If this happens	What the prototype does	What you told us
Two clients want the same opening	Only one client holds the offer at a time, and each stylist's time slot can only be offered once at a time, even if it's entered twice, so two people can never both be booked into it.	<i>"two clients expected the same Saturday haircut"</i>
A client opts out or is booked	The waitlist is re-checked before every text, so anyone who opted out or was booked into another opening in the meantime is skipped.	<i>"Some clients may opt out of texts"</i>
A YES comes in too late	They get a polite text saying it's no longer available and they're still on the waitlist.	<i>"We have to tell them it's gone, which is awkward."</i>
A text doesn't go through	It's retried automatically. If it still fails, that client is skipped and staff are told to check the number.	<i>"a message not reaching someone"</i>
An unclear reply, like maybe later?	The client is asked to answer YES or NO, and staff see a flag with one-click Mark yes and Mark no buttons.	<i>"Replies can also be unclear"</i>
Nobody takes the opening	It's marked unfilled and staff are told, so you can step in yourselves.	<i>"we need to know when the process stops"</i>
You need to call it off	Staff can cancel an opening at any time, and whoever holds the offer is told.	<i>"cancel it if the client changes their mind"</i>
The computer running it restarts	Every opening picks up exactly where it was, countdown included.	<i>"an opening quietly stalling"</i>



A simulated client phone: the offer, an unclear reply, and a polite request to answer YES or NO.

REAL VS. SIMULATED

What's real in this prototype, and what isn't yet.

How it decides who to text, when to move on and what to tell people is real and working. Anything that would reach real clients or your real records is simulated for now.

Working in the prototype

- ✓ Creating an opening in a few seconds, and cancelling it at any time
- ✓ Matching clients by service, time and stylist, in waitlist order, and never texting anyone who opted out
- ✓ One offer at a time, the 15- and 60-minute holds, and moving on by itself after a NO or no reply
- ✓ Confirmations, front-desk notes, letting others know it's filled, and polite replies to a late YES
- ✓ Retrying failed texts, flagging unclear replies, and telling staff when an opening goes unfilled
- ✓ Picking up exactly where it was if the computer restarts
- ✓ The staff board, plus on-screen client phones so you can play the client

Simulated or left out, for now

- **Texts** appear on simulated phones on screen. No real texting service is connected yet.
- **The waitlist** is sample data with made-up names and 555 numbers, not your Google Sheet.
- **Square** isn't connected, as you chose: "We don't need this to update Square; staff handle the real calendar."
- **The clock** runs fast for demos: 1 minute = 2 seconds, so a 15-minute hold lasts 30 seconds.
- **Not built yet:** staff logins, running on more than one computer, a quiet-hours rule (you have "no formal rule" yet), and clients joining the waitlist from the app.

PRACTICAL NEXT STEP

Next step: a two-week pilot at Juniper.

Real clients, the salon's own number and your own waitlist, so we can see whether it fills more chairs and saves you time.

The pilot

● Week 0

Set up real texting on the salon's number and import your Google Sheet waitlist.

● Weeks 1–2

Live on every cancellation inside 48 hours, with Carla watching the board instead of the phone.

● End of week 2

Review the numbers together.

Two decisions for you first

Hold time for later openings

How long a client gets to answer when the opening isn't same-day. We used 60 minutes.

Quiet hours

When texts should never go out, for example before 9am or after 8pm.

How we'll measure it

Openings filled

out of your 8–12 short-notice cancellations a week

Time spent chasing replies

timed for one normal week before the pilot, then during it

Double bookings

target: zero

SUCCESS, IN YOUR WORDS

"We'd spend much less time chasing replies, and Carla would know when the process had stopped or failed."